

## Game concept

The game that I am designing centers around the theme of love, where two psychologists communicate through email to collaboratively write a book about love. The player, initially an observer, gains access to their communication and starts to reply to one of the psychologist and imitating the other one. The challenge is for the player to maintain the belief that the real psychologist is responding, ensuring consistency in tone, style and conceptual depth. This interactive text-based game allows the player to shape the book's content. Each answer-choice impacts the direction of the outcome, making every playthrough a unique exploration of love and human connection.

## Paper prototype and gameplay rehearsal

For the paper prototype, I have pictures/drawings of the below:

**1)Email texts:** Simulations of the emails sent between the psychologists

**2)Available response cards for the player:** The player can choose from a variety of responses that corresponds to the psychologist's email. This process simulates decision-making because each card has a different approach and tone

**3)Alternative story paths:** The player's responses form the story's flow and lead to different outcomes

For the rehearsal of the gameplay, me and my partner did a role-playing session where one participant played the player and the other one played the psychologist replying to the emails. This process helped us point the below:

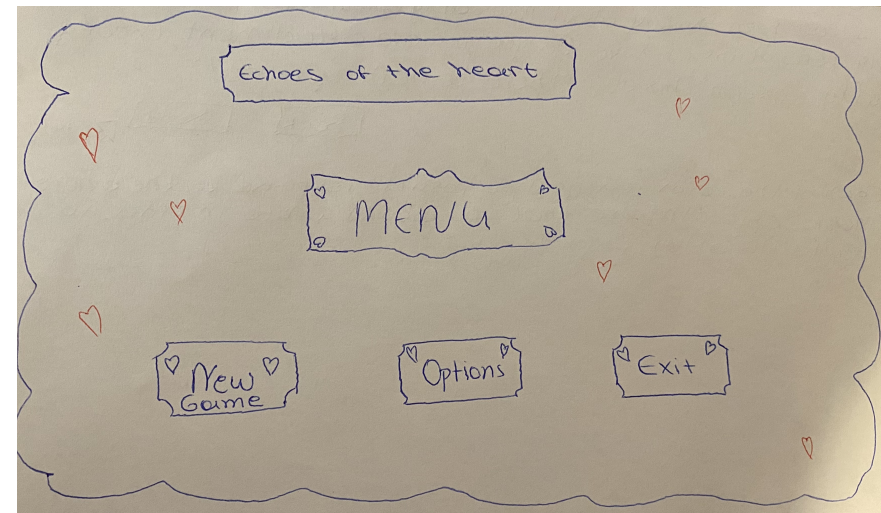
**1)How each response of the player can affect the outcome of the love book**

**2)How the player's choices-imitations give the appearance of being real**

## Results and Improvements

From the rehearsal me and my partner got some feedback and identified some possible improvements:

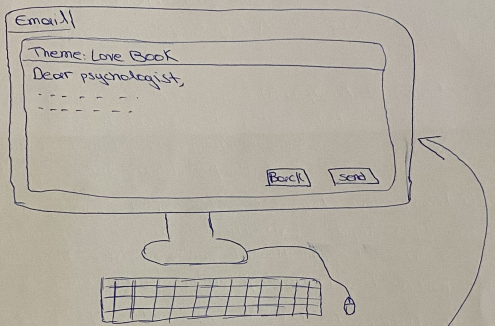
- 1)Make changes to the email timing to simulate a more natural communication and make the interactions feel more realistic**
- 2)Create a choice-based response system where the players can select from prewritten answers instead of writing alone the whole response**
- 3)Some type of scoring or feedback system to inform the players how well they are imitating the psychologist**
- 4)A possibility of the players to lose if the imitating is too far off**
- 5)A memory challenge in which the players will recall key parts of the email instead of writing the whole email**
- 6)More complex responses in order to cover a range of emotional tones and depths**



Email From psychologist A:  
"I have been thinking about how early childhood experiences shape our perception of love. Do you believe attachment theory fully explain this, or is there something more?"

Back Send Click

Each of the cards represents a possible response to the above email. Select the one that you would write in order to imitate the other psychologist.



Write or select your answer.

1st option for the player's response  
Answer: "Attachment theory certainly provides a strong foundation, but we must also consider cultural influences. Love is both psychological and social- childhood sets a framework, but life experiences reshape it over time."

Back Send

2nd option for the player's response  
Answer: "That's a great point! But what about love at first sight? Can we ignore the biological and instinctive pull that seems to defy childhood conditioning?"

Back Send

3rd option for the player's answer  
Answer: "I think love is just emotions we feel. Childhood matters, but people just love how they want to."

Back Send

Flowchart/Storyboard example

Initial Email From Psychologist A → Player chooses/writes a response:

Step 1

1) IF the player selects Option 1 (Analytical Response)

- Psychologist A continues deep discussion
- The book gains a serious, academic tone
- Player earns credibility.

2) IF the player selects Option 2 (Playful & Philosophical Response)

- Psychologist A responds with curiosity but slight skepticism
- The book takes on a mix of academic and poetic tone
- Player must continue balancing intellect and emotion

3) IF the player selects option 3 (Weak Imitation)

- Psychologist A starts questioning the authenticity of the responses
- Risk of being "found out" increases
- Player must quickly refine future responses.

Step 2

or

Step 3

If the player keeps responding well (Option 1)

- The book develops well-smoothly
- Player gains trust from psychologist A
- Successful book completion

Step 4

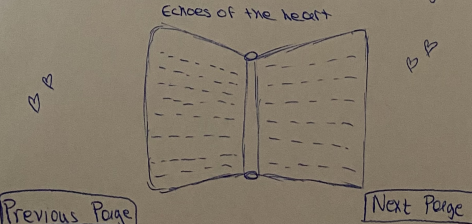
If player's responses are inconsistent (option 3)

- Psychologist A starts asking clarifying questions
- Player must refine responses or risk suspicion
- The book takes on a slightly disjointed tone

Step 5

Endgame: Regardless of the responses, the book is completed either as a cohesive academic text or a mix of styles reflecting the player's choices-writings.

Echoes of the heart



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